

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Marie Curie - A Female Icon



Learning Outcome

Accurately use information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can say and use the sound *pr*.
- I can stress new information.
- I can describe people I admire.

Ask your partner:

- Who are some famous women you know of?
- What are they famous for? Medicine? Sport?





Let's Explore!

Let's learn about a famous female scientist.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Marie Curie (1867-1934) was a famous physicist and chemist who conducted research on radioactivity. She was the first woman to win a Nobel Prize and the only person to win it twice. In addition, she was also the first woman to become a professor at the University of Paris.

Due to her incredible contribution to the scientific community, she was entombed in the Panthéon in Paris in 1996 on her own merits. She was an honest person and lived a moderate lifestyle. She did not live a life of privilege but lived a practical life. In fact, she gave much of her first Nobel Prize money to friends, family, students, and research associates.

Often, she and her husband refused to accept medals or awards. They believed that their work was more important than fame. Marie Curie had become an icon in the scientific world. To attain her scientific achievements, she had to overcome the barriers that were placed in her way because she was a woman.





Let's Practice!

Can you stress important or new information in a sentence?

Instructions: Underline the words that are stressed in the sentences. Read the text aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Marie Curie has become an icon in the scientific world. She was also the first woman to become a professor at the University of Paris. She had to overcome barriers that were placed in her way because she was a woman.



Let's Practice!

Marie Curie was a remarkable* woman.

*"Remarkable" means unusual or surprising in a positive way.

Instructions: Write the words below in the corresponding blank spaces within the text.

icon / moderate / overcome barriers / contribution / conducted / entombed

1. Due to her incredible _____ to the scientific community, she was _____ on her own merits in the Panthéon in Paris in 1996.
2. Marie Curie has become an _____ in the scientific world.
3. To attain her scientific achievements, she had _____ to that were placed in her way because she was a woman.
4. She was an honest person and lived _____ lifestyle.
5. Marie Curie (1867-1934) was a famous physicist and chemist who _____ research on radioactivity.





Extension Activity

Time to learn about the legacies of women in science.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Research another famous female scientist who won a Nobel Prize.
- Write an 80 to 100 word paragraph about her life.
- Include why you admire this scientist.
- Include at least 4 words with the consonant blend *pr*.
- Read your paragraph aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research a famous female scientist.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph about a scientist I admire.

☐ ☐

I use words with consonant blends like the word *prize*.

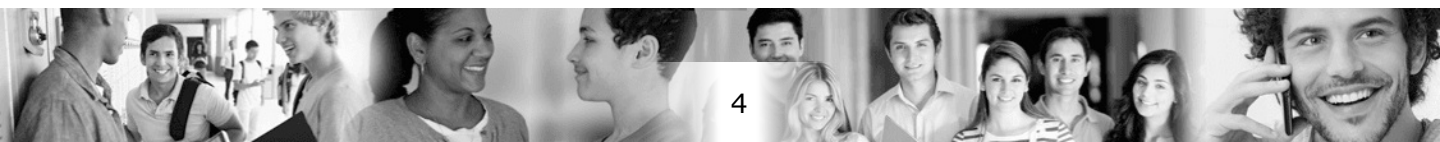
☐ ☐

I read the paragraph about a scientist to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to conduct** (verb): to plan and do something, such as an activity
e.g. Marie Curie conducted research into radioactivity.
- **radioactivity** (noun): having or producing a powerful and dangerous form of energy
e.g. Scientists study radioactivity.
- **contribution** (noun): something that is done to cause something to happen
e.g. She made a large contribution to the field of science.
- **fame** (noun): the condition of being known or recognized by many people
e.g. She was not interested in fame.
- **moderate** (adjective): not too expensive, not cheap
e.g. She lived a moderate lifestyle.
- **associate** (noun): a member of a group or organization who is at a level that is below the highest level
e.g. She gave money to her associates.
- **to entomb** (verb): to place (someone or something) in a tomb
e.g. Marie Curie is entombed in Paris.
- **privilege** (noun): a right or benefit that is given to some people and not to others
e.g. She did not live a life of privilege.
- **icon** (noun): a person who is very successful and admired
e.g. Marie Curie is an icon.
- **to overcome** (verb): to successfully deal with something
e.g. She had to overcome a lot of barriers.
- **barrier** (noun): a law, rule, or problem that makes something difficult
e.g. She had to overcome a lot of barriers.





Learning Points

The R Sound With Other Consonants

Consonant blends are a group of two or three different consonants in a word. All of the consonants are sounded or pronounced when you say the word.

For example, in the word *price*, you can hear both the letters p and r. It makes a consonant blend.

Here are some examples of consonant blends with the *pr* sound:

Examples: *prick, prize, prey, pretzel, prairie, prove, press, price, pride*

Stressing New Information

Sentence stress gives English its **rhythm** or "beat".

Word stress is emphasis on **one syllable** within a **word**.

Sentence stress is emphasis on **certain words** within a **sentence**.

Most sentences have two basic types of words:

Content words

- Content words are the keywords of a sentence. They provide the most important information of the sentence.

Structure words

- Structure words are not the key words. They are words that you use to connect key words in a sentence.

New Information Stress

When you answer a question with new information, you put stress on the requested information.

For example:

Where do you come from? - I am from **Cambridge**, in the USA.

What do you need to do? - I need to **go to the bank**

When does the movie begin? - The movie begins at **8:00**.

